

Origin, Self, Language, Meaning, Other, Time, and Difference: A Self-Evolving Inquiry

Brent Hartshorn
brenthartshorn@proton.me

Stage 3

Abstract

This is stage 3 of a self-evolving document. Its symbolic core declares 7 terms (origin, self, language, meaning, other, time, difference) and poses 11 questions through 11 relations. The supporting engine, introspected from its own source, exposes `code_blocks`, `to_questions`, `to_latex`, `to_dsl`, `title`, `abstract`, `state_summary`, `build_prompt`, `build_tex`, `build_pdf`, `dsl_docs`, `reset`, `stage`, `term`, `rel`, `dsl_to_python`, `activate_code`, `apply_oracle`, `evolve`; it parses the core, renders it, generates the questions, and emits the next stage. Continuing the author's program on emergent DSLs and self-modification, the document is an apparatus that regenerates these questions across iterations: it poses them, and makes no claim to resolve them.

Symbolic core

The evolving core of the document, rendered from its source:

$$\begin{aligned}\Omega &\longrightarrow \Sigma \\ \Sigma &\models \Sigma \\ \Sigma &\otimes \Lambda \\ \partial\Sigma &\stackrel{?}{=} \mu \\ \Sigma &\not\prec \Omega \\ \Phi &\longrightarrow \Sigma \\ \Phi &\rightsquigarrow \Sigma \\ Tau &\Rightarrow \Lambda \\ \partial\Lambda &\rightsquigarrow \mu \\ \Delta &\dashrightarrow \mu \\ \partial Tau &\otimes \Delta\end{aligned}$$

Terms

Ω origin

Σ self

Λ language

μ meaning

Φ other

Tau time

Δ difference

Reading (relations and their intent)

- $\Omega \longrightarrow \Sigma$ — genesis
- $\Sigma \models \Sigma$ — the reflexive claim
- $\Sigma \otimes \Lambda$ — reached only through language
- $\partial\Sigma \stackrel{?}{=} \mu$ — is the self's changing the same as meaning?
- $\Sigma \not\leftarrow \Omega$ — not merely its origin
- $\Phi \longrightarrow \Sigma$ — the self is given by the other
- $\Phi \rightsquigarrow \Sigma$ — the other haunts the self
- $Tau \Rightarrow \Lambda$ — time writes upon the word
- $\partial\Lambda \rightsquigarrow \mu$ — the shift in language is haunted by vanished meaning
- $\Delta \dashrightarrow \mu$ — difference shatters stable meaning
- $\partial Tau \otimes \Delta$ — the passage of time is carried by difference

Questions this stage poses

- Does origin give rise to self — and what, if anything, precedes origin?
- On what does self entailing self rest, or is it simply assumed?
- When self is carried by language, what survives and what is lost?
- Is the change in self the same as meaning, or is meaning supplied by whoever reads the change in self?
- If self does not reduce to origin, where does the remainder come from?
- Does other give rise to self — and what, if anything, precedes other?
- Does other haunt self — present in self precisely as an absence?
- What residue remains because time leaves a trace upon language?

- Does the change in language haunt meaning — present in meaning precisely as an absence?
- What collapses when difference shatters the structure of meaning?
- When the change in time is carried by difference, what survives and what is lost?

Lineage

This iteration continues the author's program on emergent DSLs, introspective generation, and self-modification [5, 3, 4, 1]. It is an apparatus that regenerates the questions above across iterations; it does not claim to resolve them.

Evolution (this stage)

The oracle supplied the DSL below, which compiled to the Python beneath it and was executed (sandboxed) to produce this stage.

Oracle (DSL):

```

“python
if ">" not in OPS:
    OPS.append(">")

OP_TEX[">"] = r"\dashrightarrow"
OP_Q[">"] = "What collapses when {a} shatters the structure of {b}?"
OP_GLOSS[">"] = "rupture"

““

/* self.dsl - stage 3 ; survives PDF extraction */

nu : 3 ;
Omega : origin ;
Sigma : self ;
Lambda : language ;
mu : meaning ;
Phi : other ;
Tau : time ;
Delta : difference ;

Omega -> Sigma ; /* genesis */
Sigma |= Sigma ; /* the reflexive claim */
Sigma (x) Lambda ; /* reached only through language */
@Sigma ?= mu ; /* is the self's changing the same as meaning? */
Sigma -< Omega ; /* not merely its origin */
Phi -> Sigma ; /* the self is given by the other */
Phi ~> Sigma ; /* the other haunts the self */
Tau *> Lambda ; /* time writes upon the word */
@Lambda ~> mu ; /* the shift in language is haunted by vanished meaning */
Delta !> mu ; /* difference shatters stable meaning */
@Tau (x) Delta ; /* the passage of time is carried by difference */

```

Compiled Python (only builder calls):

```

reset()
stage(3)
term('Omega', 'origin')
term('Sigma', 'self')
term('Lambda', 'language')
term('mu', 'meaning')
term('Phi', 'other')
term('Tau', 'time')
term('Delta', 'difference')
rel('Omega', '->', 'Sigma', 'genesis')
rel('Sigma', '|=', 'Sigma', 'the reflexive claim')
rel('Sigma', '(x)', 'Lambda', 'reached only through language')
rel('@Sigma', '?=', 'mu', "is the self's changing the same as meaning?")
rel('Sigma', '-<', 'Omega', 'not merely its origin')
rel('Phi', '->', 'Sigma', 'the self is given by the other')
rel('Phi', '~>', 'Sigma', 'the other haunts the self')
rel('Tau', '*>', 'Lambda', 'time writes upon the word')
rel('@Lambda', '~>', 'mu', 'the shift in language is haunted by vanished meaning')
rel('Delta', '!>', 'mu', 'difference shatters stable meaning')
rel('@Tau', '(x)', 'Delta', 'the passage of time is carried by difference')

```

Appendix: self-extraction

This PDF carries its support code (`dsl.py`, `self.dsl`) and the hand-off prompt (`prompt.txt`) as embedded file streams. Requires `pip install pypdf` and a LaTeX installation. To produce the next iteration, save this PDF and run:

```

import base64
exec(base64.b64decode(
    "aW1wb3J0IHN5cywgZ2xvYiwgb3MKc3lzLnBhdGguaW5zZXJ0KDAsIClIuIi"
    "kKZnJvbSBweXBkZiBpbXBvcnQUGRmUmVhZGVyCnBkZiA9IG1heChnbG9i"
    "Lmdsb2IoIioucGRmIiksIGtleT1vcy5wYXRoLmdldG10aW1lKQpyID0gUG"
    "RmUmVhZGVyKHhkZikKZm9yIG5hbWUsIGRhdGEgaW4gci5hdHRhY2htZW50"
    "cy5pdGVtcygpOgogICAgb3BlbiYwY1lLCAid2IiKS53cm10ZShkYXRhWz"
    "BdIGlmIGlzaW5zdGFuY2UoZGF0YSwgbGlzdCkgZWxzZSBkYXRhKQppbXBv"
    "cnQgaW1wb3J0bGllLCBkc2w7IGltdG9ydGxpYi5yZWxvYWQoZHNsKTsgZH"
    "NsLmV2b2x2ZSgpCg=="))

```

References

- [1] B. Hartshorn, *Iterating a Fractal-like Self Awareness Naturally*. viXra:2505.0195. <https://ai.vixra.org/abs/2505.0195>
- [2] B. Hartshorn, *Nature vs Nurture*. viXra:2505.0141. <https://ai.vixra.org/abs/2505.0141>
- [3] B. Hartshorn, *Emergent Self-Modification and Meta-Programming in Dynamic Systems*. viXra:2507.0036. <https://ai.vixra.org/abs/2507.0036>
- [4] B. Hartshorn, *Self-Contained Multi-AI Architecture Definition via DSL*. viXra:2507.0074. <https://ai.vixra.org/abs/2507.0074>

- [5] B. Hartshorn, *Towards Self-Evolving AGI: Multi-Modal Learning and Introspective Knowledge Generation via Emergent DSL*. viXra:2507.0104. <https://ai.vixra.org/abs/2507.0104>
- [6] B. Hartshorn, *Non-Quadratic Scaling and Beyond Sequential Processing*. viXra:2507.0109. <https://ai.vixra.org/abs/2507.0109>